

Seventh International Olympiad in Theoretical, Mathematical and Applied Linguistics

Wrocław (Poland), 26–31 July 2009

Individual Contest Solutions

Problem #2. The N’Ko script is written and read from right to left. The script is an alphabet: each letter stands for a consonant or a vowel. The letters within a word are joined.

- (a) A tilde above a vowel letter means low tone, its absence means high tone. But a vowel has middle tone if it is marked in the same way as the one before it (if both either have or lack tildes).

ⵓⵜⵉⵎⵉⵏⵏ — **bìlákòró**

ⵓⵏⵓⵏ — **tájula**

kòrikóri — ⵓⵜⵉⵎⵉⵏⵏⵓⵏ

báwò — ⵓⵏⵓⵏ

- (b) If two adjacent syllables have the same vowel and both letters should have a tilde or neither should have one according to the rules, only the second vowel is written.

ⵓⵏⵓⵏⵓⵏ — **kòlóló**

ⵓⵏⵓⵏ — **támene**

ⵓⵏⵓⵏⵓⵏ — **wólowolo**

létere — ⵓⵏⵓⵏⵓⵏ

bìlakóro — ⵓⵜⵉⵎⵉⵏⵏⵓⵏ

jàmanaké — ⵓⵏⵓⵏⵓⵏ